THE WHOLE STORY · SMALL GROUP GUIDE · WEEK 2 OF 52

The Whole Story in Four Acts

Luke 24:44–47 · Genesis 1–3 · Revelation 21–22

The big idea: The Bible is one story in four acts: Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration. It happened in real history, and two threads run through it from the first page to the last: the Lamb, and God with his people.

Before you meet: Read

Luke 24:28–47 | Genesis 2:8–10 | Revelation 22:1–5

Open (5 minutes)

If you had one minute to tell the whole story of the Bible, where would you start, and where would you end?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

They recognized Jesus when he took the _____, blessed and broke it, and gave it to them. *(Luke 24:30–31)*

"Did not our hearts _____ within us while he talked to us on the road?" *(Luke 24:32)*

Jesus said everything written about him in the Law of Moses and the Prophets and the _____ must be fulfilled. *(Luke 24:44)*

Discuss

1. Name the four acts of the Bible's story in your own words. Which one do people around you understand least? *Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration*

2. Read Genesis 2:8–10 and Revelation 22:1–5 side by side. What is the same? What is better at the end?

3. Which of the two threads, the Lamb or God with his people, are you most curious to follow this year? Why? *Genesis 22:8; Revelation 21:3*

Memory verse

> *"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he interpreted to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself."*
>
> **Luke 24:27**

Pray

Thank God that his story runs from a garden to a city, and that through Jesus there is a place in it for you. Ask him to make you able to tell the story to someone else.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 2

The Whole Story in Four Acts

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Luke 24:28–47 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 1 and Psalm 19).

Main points to land

1. The whole Bible fits into four acts: Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration. The ending (Revelation 22) answers the beginning (Genesis 2).
2. We are reading real history. The series follows a dated timeline from creation to the early church.
3. The goal of this study is to meet Christ, whose death and resurrection bring forgiveness to all who turn and trust him (Luke 24:47).

Answer key (Observe)

1. bread
2. burn
3. Psalms

Questions people will ask

Do we have to believe the earth is about six thousand years old?

The series follows the Bible's numbers at face value, but faithful Christians, including Reformed ones, have read the early chapters of Genesis in more than one way. What is not negotiable is that God created everything, that Adam was a real man, and that the fall was a real event. Keep the group on the main point.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you that the whole story is yours, from creation to the new creation, and that it centers on your Son, who died and rose so that forgiveness could be offered to every nation. Help us follow the threads, and bring us home to the city where you live with your people. Amen.